

Boat Purchase Analysis — 2026 Nautique G23

Independent market verification · August 16, 2026 · All prices re-checked against current listings

RECOMMENDATION: PROCEED AT \$329,100 — a fair market price, and buying now beats waiting.

Condition: this makes sense if the current boat's lack of power genuinely limits use. The upgrade costs roughly \$40,000–\$45,000 per year of ownership — the deal is fair, but it is not a bargain that pays for itself.

1. THE DEAL

Sticker (MSRP) — loaded build: 630 hp supercharged engine, telescoping tower, full options	\$409,000
Negotiated price (includes triple-axle trailer)	\$329,100
Discount off sticker (\$79,900 off)	19.5%

- **The \$409,000 sticker is legitimate.** An Idaho dealer lists a 2026 G23 with the same telescoping tower but the smaller 450 hp engine at \$378,781; the 630 hp upgrade runs about \$30,000 — that lands right at \$409,000.
- **19.5% off is the going rate, not a special favor.** Dealers publicly advertise about 17% off before anyone negotiates; owner forums report 15–20% as normal, 25% in some regions.
- **Ignore the "25% effective discount" pitch.** It compares today's price to a guessed next-year sticker; no published evidence supports the claimed 7% increase (recent years ran 4–6%). The real discount is 19.5%.

2. ROOM TO ASK FOR A LITTLE MORE — AND WHY

The dealer is at the middle of the observed discount range, not the edge. A polite ask for another **\$8,000–\$12,000 off (target \$317,000–\$321,000, about 21.5–22.5% off)** is backed by real leverage — and every \$10,000 off also saves \$600 of sales tax, so the true swing is **\$10,600 per \$10,000**:

- **Precedent:** 25% discounts are documented in some regions; ~17% is the advertised starting point at some dealers. 19.5% is a mid-range outcome, not a ceiling.
- **Market pressure:** 63% of dealers say new-boat inventory is too high, wake boat retail is down ~10% this year, listings sit 37% longer than a year ago, and dealers pay floor-plan interest every month a boat sits.
- **Timing:** late season, with 2027 models already listing — a 2026 sold now beats one carried into spring.
- **Cross-shop leverage:** loaded G23 Paragons (higher trim, same 630 hp engine) advertise at \$365,000–\$389,000 — an honest comparison worth naming.
- **If they hold on price, take it in kind:** freight/prep in writing, first service, cover/accessories. Worst case is a "no."

3. QUESTIONS TO ASK THE DEALER — WITH THE NUMBERS BEHIND THEM

Question	Why it matters
"Is freight and prep included in the \$329,100, in writing?"	Currently unconfirmed — a \$3,000–\$8,000 surprise if it isn't.
"What exactly will you give me on trade, in writing?"	Decision rule: trade only beats selling private if the private sale would net under \$118,720 (trade offer + 6% tax credit). A real 2020 G23 trade offer on record was \$112,000.
"Can you get closer to \$317,000–\$320,000?"	That's 21.5–22.5% off — inside the documented 15–25% range, in a market where 63% of dealers report excess inventory.
"How many 2026 G23s do you have left, and when do 2027s arrive?"	The more 2026 stock they're carrying into the 2027 arrivals, the more room they have. Listings are sitting 37% longer than last year.
"What's the warranty term on the supercharged ZZ8S engine specifically?"	Nautique's coverage is 5-year bow-to-stern; confirm the supercharged engine carries the full term — it's the most expensive component to repair out of warranty.
"You said prices rise 7% next year — will you show me the factory notice?"	Recent increases ran 4–6% and nothing published supports 7%. If it's real they can show it; if not, it's a sales line.

4. WHAT THE 2020 BOAT IS WORTH

Year	Asking price	Detail	Source
2020	\$149,900	450 hp, 124 hrs — Mooresville, NC	OnlyInboards
2020	\$149,995	450 hp, 61 hrs — Irvine, CA (sale pending)	YachtWorld
2020	\$149,995	Dealer retail — Montgomery, TX	Boatzon
2020	\$124,967	Jacksons Gap, AL (low end)	Boat Trader
2020	\$155,000	Bakersfield, CA (high end)	Boat Trader
2021	\$158,000 SOLD	263 hrs — actual sale, May 2025	OnlyInboards
2019	\$119,500–\$134,900	Three listings, TX / UT	Boatzon

- Boats are selling 5–12% below asking. **Private sale: plan on about \$130,000** (range \$125,000–\$138,000; \$135,000+ takes low hours and patience). **Dealer trade-in: about \$112,000** (range \$108,000–\$118,000).

5. NET COST TO SWITCH (IDAHO 6% SALES TAX)

	Trade in at \$112,000	Sell private at \$130,000
Purchase price	\$329,100	\$329,100
Amount that gets taxed	\$217,100 (price minus trade)	\$329,100 (full price)
Sales tax at 6%	+ \$13,026	+ \$19,746
Money back from the 2020	– \$112,000	– \$130,000
Net cost to switch	\$230,126	\$218,846

- Plain English:** trading in saves \$6,720 of tax, but selling private brings in \$18,000 more cash — **selling private comes out about \$11,300 ahead.**
- Sensitivity:** each \$10,000 more (or less) on the 2020's private sale moves the net cost dollar-for-dollar — sell at \$120,000 and the net cost is \$228,846 (about even with trading in); sell at \$138,000 and it drops to \$210,846.

6. BUY NOW VS. WAIT THREE YEARS

Buying now costs \$253,000 in 2029 terms: the \$218,846 net outlay above, plus \$34,500 that money would have earned invested at 5% for three years. **Waiting means:** keep the 2020 (worth roughly \$100,000 by 2029), then buy new at 2029 prices, paying 6% tax on the full price.

If you wait until 2029...	2029 sticker	Price paid	Net cost then	Buying now saves
Best case: prices rise 5%/yr, 20% discounts persist	\$473,000	\$379,000	\$301,500	\$48,000
Middle case: prices rise 6%/yr, 15% discount	\$487,000	\$414,000	\$338,900	\$85,600
Worst case: prices rise 7%/yr, discounts shrink to 10%	\$501,000	\$451,000	\$379,000	\$125,700

- **Buying now is cheaper in every scenario tested** — by \$48,000 to \$126,000 — and skips three more years with the underpowered boat.
- Fair caveat: waiting ends with a brand-new 2029 boat instead of a three-year-old 2026. It only approaches a tie if big discounts persist, price increases stay low, invested cash earns ~10%, and the 2020 holds value unusually well — all at once.

7. WHAT THE SWITCH REALLY COSTS OVER 4 YEARS

	Buy the 2026	Keep the 2020
Value today / purchase basis	\$329,100	~\$130,000
Estimated value in 2030	\$185,000–\$205,000	\$95,000–\$105,000
Value lost over 4 years (depreciation)	\$125,000–\$145,000	\$25,000–\$35,000
Sales tax paid (gone either way)	\$19,746	—
Investment return given up on the cash (5%/yr)	~\$47,000	—
Extra cost of switching, 4 years	~\$165,000–\$180,000 — about \$40,000–\$45,000 per year	

That is the honest price of running a new 630 hp boat under full warranty instead of the 2020. The discount doesn't change it — the justification is use and enjoyment, not economics.

8. RESALE NOTES

- Nautique's 2025 full G-Series redesign is pushing down values of all older-body G23s — the 2020 included — with roughly 130 leftover new old-body boats being cleared at discounts. **That argues for selling the 2020 sooner, not later.** The 2026 is the new body style, which helps its future resale.
- Worth one call before signing: loaded G23 Paragons with the same engine ask \$365,000–\$389,000 — for \$30,000–\$50,000 more it may be the stronger long-term hold.

Sources: current listings on Boat Trader, OnlyInboards, YachtWorld, Boatzon and dealer sites; Idaho State Tax Commission (6% rate and trade-in credit rules); PlanetNautique owner forums (actual trade offers and discount reports); NMMA retail data and Trade Only Today dealer-sentiment surveys (inventory and days-on-market figures). Listing prices are asking prices unless marked SOLD. Full source URLs are in the companion detailed report (boat-deal-verification.md).